

Question:
A mental health volunteer is interviewing locals as part of a community outreach program. A 46-year-old man discloses that he has felt sad for as long as he can remember. He feels as though his life is cursed and if something terrible can happen to him, it usually will. He has difficulty making decisions and feels hopeless. He also feels that he has had worsening suicidal ideations, guilt from past problems, energy, and concentration over the past 2 weeks. He is otherwise getting enough sleep and able to hold a job. Which of the following statement best describes this patient's condition?
Answer Choices:
A. The patient is at risk for double depression.
B. The patient may have symptoms of mania or psychosis.
C. The patient is likely to show anhedonia.
D. The patient likely has paranoid personality disorder.

Reasoning + Answer:

<think>
Finding Reasoning Paths :
1. **Sad mood + worsening suicidal ideation + significant weight loss** â Major Depressive Disorder (MDD) with Anorexia Nervosa .
2. **Sad mood + pervasive hopelessness + difficulty making decisions** â Major Depressive Disorder (MDD).
3. **Worsening suicidal ideation + feeling that bad things happen to him** â Major Depressive Disorder (MDD) with Suicidal Ideation .
4. **Chronic sadness (since childhood) + hopelessness + pervasive pessimism** â Major Depressive Disorder (MDD) with Chronic Pervasive Pessimism .
5. **Difficulty making decisions + hopelessness** â Major Depressive Disorder (MDD).
6. **Feeling that bad things happen to him** â Social Phobia .
7. **Hedonic anhedonia** â Major Depressive Disorder (MDD).

Reasoning Process :
1. **Sad mood + worsened suicidal ideation + significant weight loss** :
- The patient reports a chronic sad mood , worsening suicidal ideation , and significant weight loss . These symptoms strongly suggest Major Depressive Disorder (MDD) with Anorexia Nervosa . Anorexia Nervosa is characterized by significant weight loss due to reduced appetite or other related mechanisms .

2. **Sad mood + pervasive hopelessness + difficulty making decisions** :
- The patient feels hopeless and has difficulty making decisions , which are core symptoms of Major Depressive Disorder (MDD). These features align with MDD rather than other conditions like psychosis or schizophrenia .

3. **Worsening suicidal ideation + feeling that bad things happen to him** :
- The patient has worsened suicidal ideation , which is a key feature of Major Depressive Disorder (MDD). The belief that bad things happen to him is also consistent with depressive thinking patterns and does not suggest psychosis or schizophrenia .

4. **Chronic sadness (since childhood) + hopelessness + pervasive pessimism** :
- Chronic sadness since childhood , hopelessness , and pervasive pessimism are classic features of Major Depressive Disorder (MDD) with a chronic or recurrent course . These symptoms are unlikely to be explained by other psychiatric conditions like schizophrenia or anxiety disorders .

5. **Difficulty making decisions + hopelessness** :
- Decision-making difficulties and hopelessness are hallmark symptoms of Major Depressive Disorder (MDD). These symptoms do not suggest psychosis or schizophrenia .

6. **Feeling that bad things happen to him** :
- The belief that bad things happen to him is a depressive symptom and does not suggest psychosis or schizophrenia . This is more consistent with Major Depressive Disorder (MDD) with a pervasive pessimistic outlook .

7. **Hedonic anhedonia** :
- Hedonic anhedonia , the loss of pleasure in activities previously enjoyed , is a core symptom of Major Depressive Disorder (MDD). This further supports the diagnosis .

Conclusion :
The patient likely has Major Depressive Disorder (MDD), which may be complicated by :
- Anorexia Nervosa (worsened by depression and hedonic anhedonia).
- Suicidal ideation due to significant depressive symptoms .
- Chronic pellucid depression with pervasive pessimism .
- Decision-making difficulties and difficulty thinking optimistically .

These symptoms strongly align with Major Depressive Disorder (MDD) rather than other psychiatric conditions like schizophrenia or anxiety disorders . The diagnosis highlights the importance of addressing both depressive symptoms and related complications (e.g ., anorexia , suicidal ideation) for effective treatment .
</think>
<answer>
The patient is likely to show anhedonia .
</answer>